

- Some agents will have an extensive local network to help you get advance access to off-market deals. This is a great bonus, but if you can find an agent capable of this, you'll need to be prepared to be particularly detailed in your expectations and committed to following through. It might not be reasonable to expect quite as much attention or hand-holding from this type of agent.
- Don't just go with the first person you find (unless they happen to have stellar answers to your questions). Interview a few agents and choose the person who is best able to guide you, a first-time home buyer, through this crazy world of contracts and closing.